Minutes of the
General Government Committee
2019 Capital Budget & Long Range Capital Forecast Meeting
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall
At 7:00 p.m. on February 11, 2019

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order

Chair Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Opening Comments

Sheila Strain, Director of Finance/Treasurer, provided a brief presentation and overview of the Town's 2019 Capital Budget and 2020-2023 Long Range Capital Forecast, the contents of the attached report, and the recommendations contained therein. S. Strain discussed capital budget project categories, 2019 total capital budget allocation, project funding sources, capital reserve allocations, reserve contributions by source, spending cap guidelines, federal gas tax revenues, long-term and outstanding debt, and highlights of the 2019 capital budget.

Mayor Collier, Budget Chair, thanked staff for their work and reviewed the contents of the proposed 2019 Capital Budget and 2020-2023 Long Range Capital Forecast. Mayor Collier noted that the capital budget builds on the accomplishments of previous terms of council, while also incorporating the perspectives and priorities of the new Council.

4. Opening Public Comments/Questions

Chair Collier noted that public comments and questions would be invited both before and after the committee's deliberations on the capital budget document.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, thanked staff for their work on the capital budget and encouraged members of Council to consider whether any lower-priority projects could be delayed or removed in order to reduce costs where possible.

Linda Robbins, Ajax resident, inquired about timing of funding for traffic calming on Elm Street, and bike lanes included in the capital budget. Dave Meredith, Acting Director of Planning & Development Services, noted that traffic calming on Elm Street is included in the Long Range Capital Forecast, the timing of which is prioritized against other traffic calming needs in the Town, and addressed bike lanes in the capital budget.

Janice Mitchell, Ajax resident, inquired about the overall costs of construction for washroom facilities at Paradise Park, realignment of Lakeview Boulevard, and conservation restoration activities occurring in the vicinity of the park. Catherine Bridgeman, Acting Director of Operations and Environmental Services, reviewed the public engagement undertaken for the Paradise Park development, modifications made based on public feedback, and comparable washroom facilities at Rotary Park. D. Meredith reviewed the environmental assessment process used to determine the final road alignment for Lakeview Boulevard.

5. Review of Budget/Forecast

Chair Collier directed the committee through a section-by-section review of the capital budget and report.

2019 Capital Budget and 2020-2023 Long Range Capital Forecast Report

There were no comments or questions from Committee members on the contents of the report.

2019 Capital Budget and 2020-2023 Long Range Capital Forecast Document

Questions and discussion focused primarily upon the following projects:

Studies and Other Initiatives

CCD002: Pan Am Legacy Art Project
CCD003: Public Art Acquisition – Refugee Sculpture
Committee members asked questions regarding how costs are determined for the purchase of public art and the necessity of the installations. Tracey Vaughan, Director of Recreation, Culture, and Community Development, noted that prices are determined by comparable market estimates and reviewed the context and importance of each piece.

Technology

ITS004: Hardware Upgrade Replacement 2020 – 2023
Committee members asked questions regarding types of equipment being replaced and whether repair is more appropriate than replacement. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative and Information Services / Town Clerk, reviewed equipment being replaced and discussed replacement costs compared to repairs.

ITS005: Workstation Replacement 2020-2023
Committee members asked questions regarding hardware standards for employees, number of replacement units purchased annually, and the purchasing process. N. Cooper reviewed employee hardware standards. Paul Edwards, Manager of Information Technology Services, reviewed the procurement process for replacement workstation computers.

ITS006: Microsoft Office Upgrade
Committee members asked questions regarding Microsoft Windows and Office licensing costs and models. N. Cooper reviewed licensing costs, the Town's practice of purchasing workstations with operating systems pre-loaded, and potential for cost savings through the Region of Durham's Microsoft Enterprise License Agreement.

Town Buildings

BMT024: Hartrick House – Renovations
Committee members asked questions regarding Hartrick House usage, recent facility construction, demand for event venues in Ajax, and heritage elements of the facility. T. Vaughan reviewed events and usage levels for the Hartrick House. C. Bridgeman discussed recent reconstruction at the facility in 2018 and incorporation of aesthetic heritage elements when implementing renovations.

BMT010: Facility Energy Audits
Committee members inquired about the need to conduct to energy audits on LEED certified structures. D. Meredith noted that the audits provide information used in required annual reporting and to calculate greenhouse gas emissions.

BMT044: St. Francis Centre - Window Restoration
Committee members asked for clarification regarding the work history of the stained glass windows at St. Francis Centre and associated costs. C. Bridgeman reviewed restorative work performed on the St. Francis Centre and expertise needed to restore the facility's stained glass windows.

Parks and Open Spaces

ENG023: Horne Park Playground Replacement
Committee members asked questions regarding whether other assets at Horne Park would remain accessible during replacement of the playground equipment. C. Bridgeman noted the remainder of the park would remain open to the public.

ENG056: Park Retrofit – Westney Heights Park
Committee members inquired about whether the baseball diamond would remain or be re-purposed. D. Meredith noted that the baseball diamond is not used for permits issued to user groups, and the 2019 Recreation and Culture Master Plan would determine the need for a baseball diamond within the area.

ENG020: Ajax Cricket Clubhouse & Field Improvements
Committee members asked questions regarding improvements to the field, coordination with the Ajax Cricket Club, and transfer for the facility to the Town. T. Vaughan noted that the Town would assist with promoting availability of the space. D. Meredith reviewed the timeline for acquisition of the facility, proposed capital improvements, and future relations with the club.

ENG021: Walkway Lighting Replacement
ENG043: Walkway Lighting Replacement – 2020-2023
Committee members asked questions regarding lighting installations along easements and other areas of concerns to residents, use of solar powered lighting, and other technologies in Town parks. C. Bridgeman reviewed the proposed replacement locations and discussed other potential locations, solar powered lighting, and other technologies.

ENG005: Frisco Road Improvements
Committee members asked for information about alignment with the City of Pickering's intention to improve trail connectivity in the area. C. Bridgeman noted that the project timing will be aligned with the City of Pickering.

ENG016: Sundial Downtown Park Phase 2 - Design
Committee members inquired about the specific location of the park and timing of the installation relative to construction of the subdivision. D. Meredith noted that the park would not be constructed until the subdivision is completed, and the capital project could be delayed as a result.

Vehicles

ENG031: Bike Counters
Committee members asked questions regarding use of the data collected. D. Meredith noted that the data collected on the Town's trails would be used to inform the future trails master plan and the Town's asset management plan to prioritize maintenance of the Town's trails. Committee members discussed the priority of the project and the value of the data collected.

Amendment

Moved by: M. Crawford

That Project Number 'ENG031: Bike Counters' be moved from the 2019 capital budget into the year 2023 of the Long Range Capital Forecast.

CARRIED

FES009: Replacement Defibrillators
Committee members asked questions regarding how many defibrillators the Town owns, and opportunities for bulk purchasing. Dave Lang, Fire Chief, noted that each fire truck is equipped with a defibrillator, and efforts are made to purchase defibrillator units in partnership with Durham Region EMS.

FLT009: Fleet – Replacement Fire Vehicles FES 2020 - 2023
Committee members asked questions regarding whether bulk purchasing is possible for fire vehicles. D. Lang reviewed the competitive procurement process undertaken when procuring vehicles for Fire and Emergency Services.

Road Networks

ETP014: Traffic Calming on Town Roads - 2019
Committee members inquired about traffic calming in specific areas not identified on the list, how areas are identified and prioritized, and the specific forms of traffic calming to be implemented. D. Meredith discussed the priority areas included in the capital project and the study process undertaken to determine priority areas and the traffic calming mechanisms to be implemented.

ENG045: Rossland Road Widening EA – Westney to Lakeridge
Committee members asked for clarification regarding the need to perform environmental assessments. C. Bridgeman noted that environmental assessments are required by provincial law for certain infrastructure projects.

ETP009: Bicycle Facilities on Town Roads - 2019
Committee members inquired about the type of infrastructure proposed to be installed at the identified locations. D. Meredith discussed the locations identified in the capital project.

ENG039: Traffic Signals Rossland Road & Riverside Drive - Construction
Committee members asked questions regarding the necessary approval from the Region of Durham. C. Bridgeman noted that the Town would approach the Region in order to seek its commitment before proceeding with the capital project.

ENG057: MUT Ravenscroft Road – Beverton/Paulynn Park
Committee members asked questions regarding whether the installation of a multi-use trail would allow for the removal of bike lanes on Ravenscroft Road. C. Bridgeman discussed the design phase to be undertaken in 2022.

ETP027 Westney Road/Millington Crescent Signalization
Committee members discussed the timing of the proposed capital project and inquired whether the design could be advanced, and when construction could occur if the design is accelerated. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee members.

Amendment

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That Council amend Project Number ETP027 Westney Road/Millington Crescent Signalization as follows:
   a. Advance project from 2023 to 2019
   b. Amend project scope to reflect the design of safety improvements and traffic signals for Westney Road / Millington Crescent intersection
   c. Revise costs to the amount of $50,000, to be funded from the Development Reserve

2. That the 2019 design recommendations and associated costs inform the 2020 capital budget process, for inclusion of construction of safety improvements and signalization for the Westney Road / Millington Crescent intersection.

3. That Staff be directed to work with the Region as required for the design of safety improvements and traffic signals, for the Westney Road / Millington Crescent intersection.

CARRIED

Stormwater Network

ETP003: Waterfront Rain Garden - Design
Committee members inquired about the proposed number and configuration of rain gardens. D. Meredith noted that the proposed design will be reviewed at a future waterfront public meeting.

ETP001: Storm Sewer Headwall Repair
Committee members asked questions regarding whether additional enhancements could be made. D. Meredith noted a report would be presented to a future GGC meeting.

ETP002: Stormwater Pond Rehabilitation – Pickering Plains Pond #23
Committee members inquired about the public consultation strategy related to the capital project. D. Meredith noted that a community consultation will be undertaken for the project.

6. Closing Public Comments/Questions

Chair Collier invited public comments and questions prior to the Committee's final consideration and approval of the complete capital budget and Long Range Capital Forecast.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, inquired about the allocation to the Election reserve, costs related to 'ENG045: Rossland Road Widening EA – Westney to Lakeridge', standards for workstation size related to 'INF005: Municipal Needs Accommodation Study', and allocations to reserves. S. Strain reviewed the allocation to the election reserve and other reserve accounts. D. Meredith reviewed negotiations with the Region of Durham regarding the Rossland Road environmental assessment. C. Bridgeman reviewed guidelines established for employee space needs.

There being no further comments, Chair Collier closed the public meeting.

Chair Collier and members of the committee thanked staff for their work on the budget, and thanked residents for their questions on the capital budget process.

7. Budget Recommendation

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the 2019 Capital Budget and 2020-2023 Long Range Capital Forecast be approved, subject to the following amendments:

    a. That Project Number 'ENG031: Bike Counters' be moved from the capital budget for the year 2019 into the year 2023 of the Long Range Capital Forecast;

b. That Council amend Project Number 'ETP027: Westney Road/Millington Crescent Signalization' as follows:

   i. Advance the project from 2023 to 2019;
   ii. Amend the project scope to reflect the design of safety improvements and traffic signals for Westney Road / Millington Crescent intersection; and
   iii. Revise costs to the amount of $50,000, to be funded from the Development Reserve

c. That the 2019 design recommendations and associated costs inform the 2020 capital budget process, for inclusion of construction of safety improvements and signalization for the Westney Road / Millington Crescent intersection; and

d. That Staff be directed to work with the Region as required for the design of safety improvements and traffic signals, for the Westney Road / Millington Crescent intersection.

2. That the following 2019 General Levy Funded Reserve Allocation be approved:

Reserve	Amount
Vehicle/Equipment Replacement	$1,657,900
Roads Maintenance	1,567,800
General Infrastructure Maintenance	908,600
Building Maintenance	781,600
Strategic Initiatives	387,000
Development	200,000
Post Growth Capital	69,000
Election	60,000
Total	$5,631,900

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (9:54 p.m.)

Moved by: S. Lee

That the February 11, 2019 meeting of the General Government Committee 2019 Capital Budget & 2020-2023 Long Range Capital Forecast, be adjourned.

CARRIED

Chair

D-Clerk